Self-actualization

Self actualization refers to an individual's need to develop his or her potentialities: in other words, to do what he or she is capable of doing. It means a person's motivation to reach his or her full potential.

Who are Self actualizers?
Self-actualizers are people who make the fullest use of their capabilities.

3.4 Individual differences

We all know that whatever lies around us in the form of non-living or living beings differ, from each other in so many respects. Humans, though we are a common species, differ in sizes, shapes, appearances, colour, personality and behaviour. There are individual variations and differences found in ourselves.

Definition of individual differencesy

It is defined as the differences among individuals, that distinguish or separate them from one another and make one as a unique individual in oneself.

Types of individual differences

1. Physical or physiological differences
2. Psychological differences

In total the differences may be found in the following respects. They are differences related to

- Physical differences
- Differences in intelligence
- Differences in attitudes
- Differences in achievement
- Differences in motor ability
- Differences on accout of sex
- Racial differences
- Differences due to nationality
- Differences due to economic status.
- Emotional differences
- Personality differences

Causes of individual differences

- Heredity
- Influence of caste, race and nation
- Sex differences
- Age an intelligence
- Temperament and emotional stability
- Economic condition and education
- Environment

Implications for Nursing

- Nurses must understand that it is quite natural for their patients and people under their care to differ in respect of their likes and dislikes, levels of IQ and understanding, tolerance for the pain, adjustment to the new situations and environment, social and emotional adjustment etc. She must plan her nursing actions considering these differences in her mind.
- The knowledge on individual differences helps nurses to learn and provide care which is unique for each individual.
- Nurses can make their patients and relatives realize that all are not same and there is no point in comparing their treatment with that of others. They cannot simply copy the treatment of others and all cannot be benefitted in the same way.
- Nurses can understand and guide or protect the patients with inferiority or superiority feelings under their care.

3.5 Attitude

The main aim of education is modification of one's behavior according to the expectations of the society. One's behaviour to a larger extent, depends upon one's attitude towards the things,idea, person, or object in his environment. The entire

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